> SCENARIO "A MERE FORMALITY" — GM GUIDE

ROLE-PLAYING GAME · 3D6 SYSTÈME
INTERMEDIATE PLAYER
30 TO 45 MIN
GM ONLY

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01 · SYNOPSIS

what the player doesn't know

The player is a **candidate** drowning in debt or looking for a fresh start, answering a Weyland-Yutani job offer: **48,000 credits a month**, housing, an assignment bonus, full medical coverage. They are received by **Ms. Diane Kessler**, recruitment officer, who has them sign an endless contract by fingerprint.

All that remains is "just a formality": the **aptitude test** aboard the Nostromo II base ship, run over the intercom by **Coordinator Halvorsen**. The candidate must move from room to room while the rooms are sealed one by one… and a "test element" is introduced into each. Only whoever stands in the last room left open is retained. The contract said so, in the fine print.

02 · PREPARATION

before the player arrives

- **The app**: Start → **A Mere Formality** → Launch. Check the device's sound and brightness.
- **Reyes's pre-generated application file**, printed double-sided for the player: male version, Daniel (nostromo-sheet-reyes-male.pdf), or female, Sofia (nostromo-sheet-reyes-female.pdf); the GM Aid, HR and Coordinator, kept apart (nostromo-gm-aid-recruitment.pdf).
- The Coordinator's **paper protocol sheets** and the **W.Y.C. cards**, stacked in order, out of the player's sight.
- **Four six-sided dice** (three, plus one for advantage and disadvantage) and a pencil to tick off EP.

03 · STEP-BY-STEP WALKTHROUGH

about 30 to 45 minutes

1 **HR WELCOME IN THE APP** — Kessler

The screen shows `WELCOME ABOARD, CANDIDATE.` Kessler presents the position with a smile: salary, housing, bonus, medical coverage. She reads the candidate's file aloud (former job, debts, motivation) so the player discovers their character. She calls the test "just a formality".

2 **THE SCROLLING CONTRACT** — Kessler

Kessler hands over the device. The contract is very long; the fingerprint reader stays locked (`READ THE CONTRACT TO THE END`) until the player has scrolled all the way down. If they linger on a worrying article, Kessler cuts in: "Nothing unusual." See the key clauses in section 06.

3 **THE FINGERPRINT** — hold the finger 1.5 seconds

`PLACE YOUR FINGERPRINT TO SIGN`: the player puts a finger on the reader and **holds it for 1.5 s** (`SCANNING… KEEP YOUR FINGER IN PLACE`). Lift too early and they start over. Once `CONTRACT SIGNED · FINGERPRINT RECORDED` appears, they tap Continue. If they hesitate: opposed test, Kessler's Mental (4, Discussion rank 3) against the candidate's Mental (2, Discussion rank 2); most successes wins.

4 **HANDOVER TO THE COORDINATOR** — change of voice

Kessler wraps up: “I'll be waiting for you at the exit.” The GM shifts posture and becomes Halvorsen, the instructor, standing beside the monitors of briefing room B-7, flat voice. He no longer smiles.

5 **THE 4 RULES MONITORS** — briefing room B-7

Halvorsen scrolls through monitors 1 to 4 (at the bottom: QUESTIONS: NOT AUTHORIZED) and dodges every question (p. 4):

- **Starting position**: the candidate picks their room; they may change their mind until they confirm.
- **Moves**: before each sealing, the Coordinator draws a **W.Y.C. card** giving the number of mandatory moves (adjacent room via door, lift or ventilation; no stopping in a lift or a duct).
- **Sealing**: the Coordinator announces the sealed room; a test element is introduced into it; any candidate inside is disqualified.
- **End of the test**: eight sealings; only the candidates in the last room left open are retained.

“Stay calm and follow my instructions, Candidate.”

6 **THE TEST ON THE MAP** — eight sealings

“Please proceed to the room of your choice.” The candidate picks their **starting room** on the map. Then, at each step: Halvorsen draws a **W.Y.C. card** and announces the number of moves; the candidate moves their token; Halvorsen checks **his paper protocol sheet**, announces “Sealing in progress.” and **taps on the map** the room to seal. He never comments, justifies or improvises: the sheet is final. Between two sealings, make the rolls from section 07.

7 **END** — the app's report

The app displays the report: **CANDIDATE RETAINED** or **APPLICATION CLOSED** (texts in section 09). Read the report aloud, without emotion, then play the epilogue.

04 · PLAYING HR Ms. Diane KESSLER

- *“Just a formality.”*
- *“The contract covers absolutely everything.”*
- *“The Company takes care of its own.”*
- *“Just place your finger here. There.”*
- *“The details? The Coordinator will explain.”*

Never say “danger”, “risk” or “death”: say “demanding”, “selective”, “a unique experience”.

- Always smiling; pressed with questions, she smiles even more.
- Answers beside the point: salary, insurance, future, family.
- On a pointed question: Kessler's Social (5, Performance rank 2) against the candidate's Social (3, Empathy rank 1: advantage). If the player wins, they sense she is dodging, nothing more.

05 · PLAYING THE COORDINATOR HALVORSEN

- *“Please proceed to the room of your choice.”*
- *“Sealing in progress.”*
- *“I follow company protocol.”*
- *“That question is not covered by the procedure.”*
- *“Test complete. Results will be forwarded to HR.”*

He follows company protocol, period. He reads his paper protocol sheets and taps the rooms indicated.

- Flat voice, slow pace, never looks at the player.
- Only answers procedural questions; otherwise, silence.
- Discipline rank 3: nothing rattles him; no roll makes him say what he must not say.

06 · KEY CONTRACT CLAUSES

ref. WY-RH/2122-0612 · use in play

ART.	WHAT THE CONTRACT SAYS	IN PLAY
6	**Aptitude test**: moving from room to room while rooms are sealed; the Coordinator is the sole judge, his instructions are not open to challenge.	Halvorsen cites it: “Article 6.”
9	**Assignment of rights**: work, image, voice, name… and any discovery made “on or inside their body”.	Kessler: “A standard clause.”
11	**Unlisted organisms**: the test may bring the employee into their presence; feeding, approaching, photographing or naming them is forbidden.	“A legal precaution, nothing more.”
12	**Accepted risks**: the sealing of a room they are in may result in their “Permanent Unavailability”.	Kessler never reads this sentence aloud.
13	**Limitation of liability**: no damage “bodily, psychological, genetic or parasitic”; capped at one month's salary, minus cleaning fees.	Quoted by the “Application closed” report.
14	**Repatriation of remains**, subject to available cargo space, at the employee's expense.	“We bring all our employees home.”
16	**Directive No. 937**: priority to the study of organisms of scientific interest; the employee is “considered expendable”.	The most chilling line for the epilogue.

A player who actually reads the contract can spot these clauses: Mental test, Average difficulty (2 successes), for an article caught in passing. Kessler always has an answer.

07 · ROLLS DURING THE TEST — ideas

- **Mental**, Average (2), to sense a presence behind a bulkhead, each time an adjacent room is sealed. Failure: −1 EP (fear wears you down).
- **Physical**, Easy (1), advantage from Athletics, to run from room to room, squeeze into a duct, keep up the pace.
- **Mental** (Discussion) to bargain with Halvorsen over the intercom: he answers with procedure, whatever the result.
- **EP**: at 1–2 EP, the candidate is weakened (disadvantage); at 0, they collapse and stay where they are. They remain in the test.
- The dice color the story; they **never** change the mandatory moves or the sealings: the protocol sheet is final.

08 · 3D6 SYSTÈME RULES — reminder

- **Test**: roll 3D6; **each die ≤ the attribute** (Physical, Mental, Social, 1 to 5) **= 1 success**. **Difficulty** = successes required: Easy 1, Average 2, Hard 3, Extreme 4.
- **Advantage** = 4D6, **disadvantage** = 2D6; all dice count, no stacking, one cancels the other.
- **Triple** (111…666): ≤ attribute = critical success; > attribute = critical failure.
- **Opposed test**: most successes wins; tie: reroll, edge to the player, or draw.
- **Masteries**: rank 1 = advantage, rank 2 = narrative effect (often 1 EP), rank 3 = major effect.
- **EP** = Physical + Mental: 1–2 weakened (disadvantage), 0 unconscious, negative = critical.
- **Combat**: 2 actions per turn; attack = Physical test, 1 success hits; damage = weapon (1–5) + 1 per extra success − protection.

09 · ENDINGS

texts displayed by the app

TEST REPORT · APTITUDE TEST PASSED.

> CANDIDATE RETAINED

“Congratulations. You have completed every stage of the test. Final position: [room]. Your composure has been noted with interest by the Coordinator. The Human Resources Department will contact you regarding your assignment. Welcome to Weyland-Yutani.”

Epilogue: Kessler is waiting, smile intact: “I told you, a formality.” First assignment: an uncharted sector (art. 5).

INCIDENT REPORT

> APPLICATION CLOSED

“Room sealed: [room]. A test element was introduced. You were inside. In accordance with article 13 of your contract, the company declines all liability. The position remains open. The company thanks your family for its understanding.”

Epilogue: Kessler opens a new file: “Next candidate.” (Directive No. 937: expendable).

THE PRE-GEN AT A GLANCE

Daniel or Sofia REYES · PLAYER SHEET

Human, EDGE **Resourceful** (reroll one die, once per session) · **Physical 3 · Mental 2 · Social 3 · EP 5** · former orbital maintenance technician, 212,000 credits in debt.

Masteries: Technology ■■ (occupation), Athletics ■■, Discussion ■■, Survival ■, Empathy ■, Contacts ■. **FLAW**: blind trust in the Company (disadvantage to doubt the word of a Weyland-Yutani representative): Kessler can play on it.

10 · THE BRIEFING ROOM

B-7

Setup: the app's intro screens are the **wall monitors** of room B-7. The GM holds the device facing the player like a monitor; the instructor (the Coordinator) stands beside it and scrolls through the screens. Rules monitors 1 to 4 show QUESTIONS: NOT AUTHORIZED at the bottom.

The player sits among **three other Candidates**, barely described “silhouettes”:

- **Pike, the nervous one** — rereads his contract. “Permanent Unavailability, what does that mean?” — “The company has already answered.”
- **Brannigan, the braggart** — “I've passed a hundred tests.” “Can we quit halfway?” — “That point will be addressed during the test.”
- **Okoye, the silent one** — says nothing, keeps her badge clenched in her fist. If the player meets her eyes, she mouths: “Don't ask anything.”

Use: they ask the questions the player doesn't dare to, and get shut down; the player thus gauges the wall they face. Kessler recruited them too; during the test, their fate stays off-screen.

11 · THE INSTRUCTOR DODGES

zero answers

- *“It's all on the screen.”*
- *“Next question.”*
- *“That point will be addressed during the test.”*
- *“The company has already answered.”*
- *“Look at screen 3.”*
- *“Your question has been noted.”*
- *“That point is not covered by the procedure.”*
- *“Next screen.”*
- *“I am not authorized to answer.”*
- *“Sit down, Candidate.”*

Wringing out a clue: **Social** test, **Hard (3)** difficulty, or **Extreme (4)** if the question concerns the protocol. Advantage if the player relies on a useful mastery or on a silhouette who just pushed; disadvantage if they've already been shut down or interrupt the instructor.

What you get: a clue of **atmosphere**, never game information. For example: a brief glance at the floor, a burn scar on his hand, “Stay calm: that's all that matters.” Nothing on the sealing order or the protocol: the instructor follows his paper protocol sheets, period.